

TorqBall — Rulebook

Grade: Best · **Role:** Flagship (the poster + the reel) · **Basically:** Rocket League with RC buggies · **Format:** standalone tournament (its own day, its own floor)

*Built 2026-09-06 from [[TorqBall — Design Study v1]] (the locked concept). This **supersedes** [[1 - TorqBall (rulebook)]], which was written in the old merged-day frame (Zone A, "switch the arena to Sumo/Capture in 3–5 min") — that doc is legacy; read it only for colour. TorqBall is not event #1 or #2 but it is TorqWars' widest-appeal game, so it gets the full standalone-event treatment now: its own boarded arena, its own tournament arc, nothing shared with TorqFall/TorqSiege/TorqCapture on the day. Pairs with [[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]] (the prototype gate — build nothing until it passes), [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]] (the full boost-system spec) and [[TorqBall — Stretch Modes]] (Hoops/Puck/Rumble/Hazard Variant).*

1. Objective

Two teams push a large, glowing ball into the opponent's goal with their cars. Most goals when the clock ends wins. Zero skill wall — "chase the ball toward that lit goal" needs no explanation, so a total first-timer is celebrating a goal inside their first match. That is why this is the flagship: it converts strangers into a cheering team faster than anything else in the set.

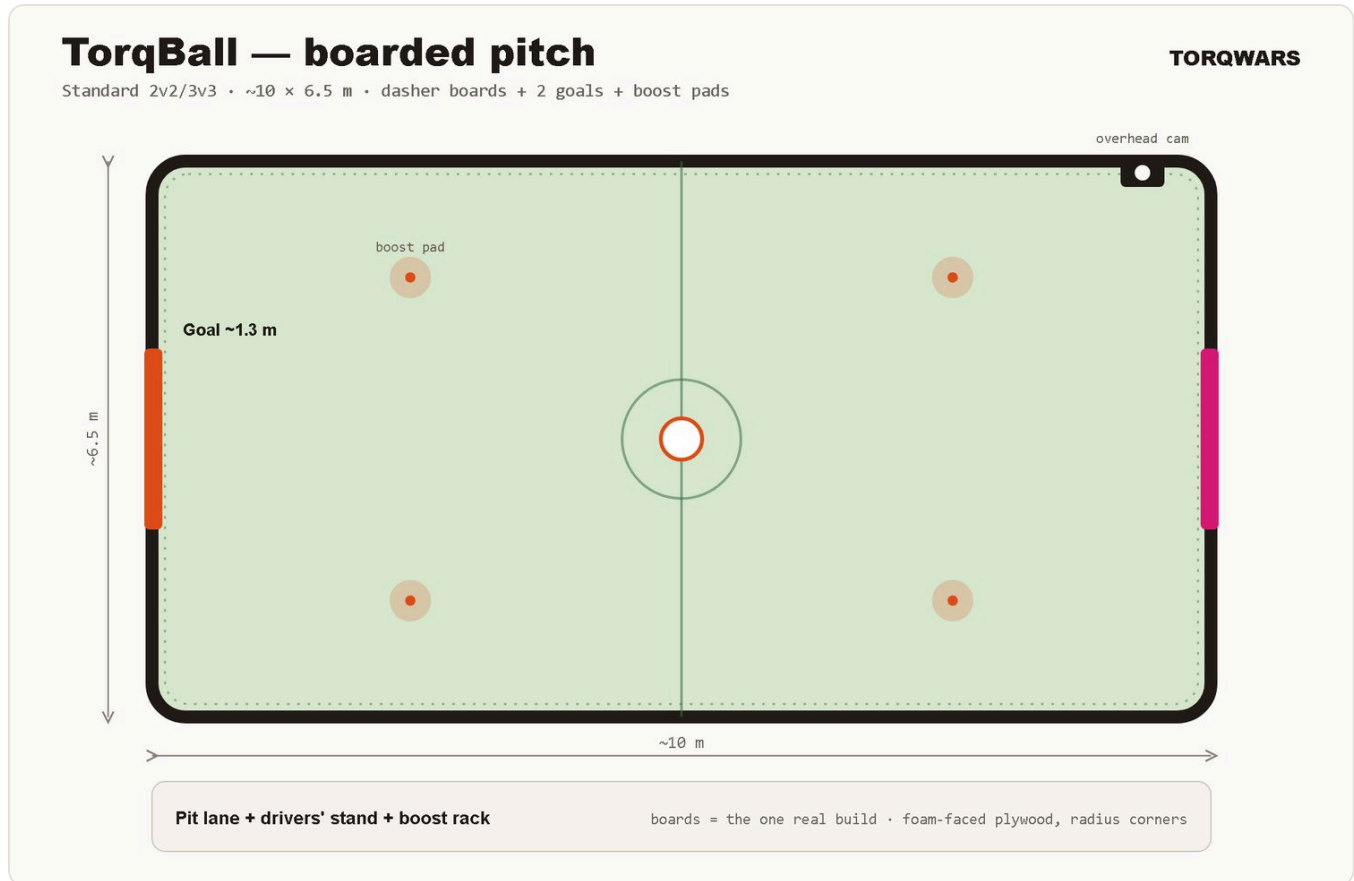
2. The honest crux (read this before building)

Rocket League's magic is aerials + boost; our cars can't fly and can't safely run raw video-game speed. TorqBall is therefore **ground car-football**, and it lives or dies on two physical things:

1. **The ball** — big, light, glowing, so a speed-capped ~1 kg car can visibly shove it, it rides over bumpers not under them, and it reads huge on camera.
2. **The boards** — a low dasher-board perimeter so ball and cars stay in and rebound cleanly off the walls (rebounds are the game).

Both are gated by [[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]]. **Do not build the full arena until that test passes.** Everything below assumes it has.

3. The arena



- **Pitch:** boarded rectangle, ~10 × 6.5 m (≈700 sq ft) — reused from the legacy rulebook's footprint, now enclosed by boards instead of open turf. (10 m × 6.5 m = 65 sq m ≈ 700 sq ft at 10.7639 sq ft/sq m — corrected 2026-09-06, was mis-printed as ≈650 sq ft.) It sits inside the shared 3000 sq ft envelope (100–300 people) with room for a drivers' stand, spectator line and the rest of the show layer. (Not the largest floor commitment in the game set overall — TorqFall's open turf runs 800–1,200 sq ft and TorqSiege's dedicated arena is ~775 sq ft, both bigger than TorqBall's ~700 sq ft; the legacy rulebook's narrower "largest Zone-A footprint" framing compared only within the old merged-day Zone-A group, not the whole game set.)
- **Boards (the one real fabrication):** modular dasher-board panels, ~35–45 cm tall — tall enough to keep a 40–60 cm ball and a bumping car inside and rebounding, low enough that an overhead camera and standing spectators still see the ball and the scrum over the top. EVA-foam-faced plywood, radius/padded corners (no square edges to snag a chassis or bruise a hand). Full build + BOM in [[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]] §Boards.
- **Goals:** two openings built into the boards at each short end, ~1.2–1.5 m wide, open to the board's full height (so the oversized ball can pass through cleanly), a shallow back-net or wall behind so a scored ball doesn't roll off into the crew area. Lit goal frame (LED strip round the opening) for scoring clarity and the night-glow look.
- **Corners:** rounded or foam-padded — a ball or a car sliding into a square corner is where jams and pinched fingers happen. Corner geometry is part of the bench test.
- **Markings:** centre line + centre spot (tape only, no floor damage) inside the boarded pitch.

4. Equipment

- **Ball:** the winning candidate from [[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]] — big (~40–60 cm), light, glowing, foam or inflatable. **3–4 spares on hand** (punctures/deflates, and Grabber-boost play needs a velcro-patched spare in rotation).
- **Cars:** speed-capped rented stock cars, rubber tyres, foam bump-rings (same rule as every other game — nothing bolted, [[Car Fleet, Scale & Protection]]). Team colours by LED/coloured tape.
- **Boost attachments:** the strap-on Plow/Scoop/Grabber kit, per [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]] — clipped on at the pit lane, never mid-match.
- **Per match, live cars by mode (§5):** **Duel 2 · Standard 4–6 · Big Party 8–12.** Big Party 6v6 (12 live) draws hard on the 12–16-car shared fleet — thin charging margin, acceptable for an exhibition slot (not a scored bracket round) but run 4v4 (8 live) as the default Big Party size if the charging rotation is tight; swap to charged cars only between matches regardless of mode.

5. Modes (v1 core)

All three v1 modes run on the **same boarded pitch** — just a different team size and clock. This is the tournament's playlist, the way TorqCapture's modes share one floor.

Mode	Teams	Match length	Role
Standard (default)	2v2 or 3v3	3 min running clock, or first to 3 goals	The bread-and-butter — group stage + most of the bracket
Duel	1v1	90 s	Tiebreaker, a fast filler when the queue is short, and a genuine skill showcase for the semis/final
Big Party	4v4 or 6v6	3 min	Max cars, glorious scrum — throughput + comedy content, run as an exhibition between blocks

- **Standard** is what a walk-in learns the game on: two teams, one ball, chase and shove.
- **Duel** strips away the crowding — one car each side, nowhere to hide, the closest thing to a real 1v1 shootout. Good for a hype semi-final or final.
- **Big Party** is not competitive depth, it's spectacle: the same pitch stuffed with 8–12 cars becomes a scrum the overhead camera eats alive. Run it as a warm-up exhibition or a between-round filler, not a scored bracket round (too chaotic to officiate fairly).

Stretch modes — Hoops (ramp-basket goal), Puck (Snow Day disc), Rumble (the boost system turned to 11) and a symmetric Hazard/Arena Variant — are speced in full in [[TorqBall — Stretch Modes]], including the build + test each needs before it's added to the playlist. None of them are required for a v1 launch.

6. The boost system in play

TorqBall's own answer to Rocket League boost — the car, the ball/goal, or a safe speed lane changes, never a per-car speed hack. Full spec (build, BOM, earn rules) lives in [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]]; the match-flow summary:

Boost	Effect	Earned via
Plow	Wide bumper — move the ball + bulldoze rivals	Boost pad
Scoop	Curved lip — lift/carry the ball a little	Boost pad
Grabber	Velcro face — ball sticks, dribble until bumped off	Boost pad
Turbo	Real speed burst — fleet-wide throttle toggle ONLY , gated on the rental club's fleet supporting it (shelved for v1 if not confirmed) — no "boost lane," low friction doesn't add speed	Fleet-wide (never per-car)
Magnet	The goal you're attacking widens ~20 s (not your own goal — it rewards pushing forward, never a defensive relief)	Boost pad

- Boost pads are lit floor pads inside the pitch; driving over one earns a boost, claimed and clipped on at the pit lane. **Standard and Duel run boost-free by default** (keeps the core game legible for a first bracket); **turn boost pads on for Big Party and for Rumble** (stretch) to raise the chaos ceiling for content.
- Pads reuse the same tag-per-car + zone-reader tech being built for TorqCapture — a pad is a tiny zone. v1 fallback: painted pads called by a marshal or the overhead cam.

7. Tournament structure

Standalone event, group stage → knockouts → final — the same arc as TorqFall/TorqSiege/TorqCapture:

Block	Format	Elimination
Group stage (bulk of the day)	Standard 2v2/3v3, round-robin heats; leaderboard on screen	Non-elim — every team gets N matches (default 3), a paid ticket never ends in one round
Knockouts (afternoon)	Standard, single-elimination bracket seeded off the group leaderboard	Loser drops to free-play + a Big Party exhibition slot
Grand Final (the climax)	Duel or Standard, full commentary, both finalist teams	The trophy moment — the hero reel

- **Between blocks:** Big Party exhibition + open free-play laps while crew resets the pitch. Nobody stands around watching an empty boarded arena.
- **Rotation within a block:** losing team rotates out; winner stays a max of 2 matches then rotates — keeps the queue fair and fresh faces on camera.

8. Match flow (marshal + tech script)

1. **Set.** Cars on their own halves behind the centre line; ball on centre spot; any boost attachments clipped on per team's earned stock.
2. **Kickoff.** Marshal countdown "3-2-1-GO", clock starts, both teams charge the ball.
3. **Play.** Continuous. Ball off a board stays live — rebounds are the game, no out-of-play stoppages.
4. **Goal.** Ball fully crosses the goal line inside the frame → marshal (or the goal-line sensor, if built) calls it, score ticks on screen, **reset:** ball to centre spot, cars to halves, kickoff again.

5. **Stuck ball** (jammed in a corner or a car pile): marshal 3-count, then free-drops the ball at the nearest neutral spot — no clock stoppage unless a car flips.
6. **Flipped/dead car**: marshal rights it in place, play continues, unless it's blocking the goal mouth — then a quick dead-ball reset.
7. **Full time**. Hooter; highest score wins. **Tie → 60 s golden goal**, or a 3-shot "penalty push" (one car vs an empty goal from centre) for content.

9. Scoring & fouls

- **Goal = 1 point**. Own-goals count for the opponent — the crowd loves it, keep it.
- **No hard fouls** — push-based contact is the point of the game. The only marshal call: deliberately pinning the ball against the boards for **more than 5 s** without contesting = free-drop to the other team.
- **No ramming a downed/flipped car** — once a car is out of the play (flipped, stuck), leave it; chasing it down is a foul (skip that driver's next kickoff or a warning). Keeps the fight on the ball, not a wrecking derby.
- **Marshal is final** — no reviews, speed of the queue depends on fast calls.

10. Safety

- **Speed-capped cars only** — beginners + a ball + a scramble in a boarded box is exactly the situation the cap exists for.
- **Foam bump-rings** on every car, zip-tied, comes off clean at handback.
- **Boards are padded/rounded at every corner and joint** — no square edge or exposed fastener a car or a hand can catch on.
- **No ramming a downed car** (§9) — this is a safety rule as much as a fairness one; a stationary flipped car near a scrum of moving cars is the one real collision risk.
- Spectators stand outside the boarded perimeter; the ball is light/soft, so a ball that clears the boards is harmless.
- Marshals never step onto the pitch with cars live at speed near them without calling "hold"; drivers ease off on "hold".

11. Reset / turnaround

- **Between matches (same mode)**: swap to charged cars, ball to centre, teams cycle — **~60–90 s turnaround**. No board changes, no surface change.
- **Between blocks (mode swap, e.g. Standard → Big Party exhibition)**: no board changes needed — Big Party is the same pitch with more cars. Only a stretch-mode swap (Hoops ramp-goals, Puck disc) needs a prop change, per [[TorqBall — Stretch Modes]].
- **Boost pads (if run)**: reset automatically if electronic (TorqCapture-tech reuse); painted-pad fallback needs no reset at all.

12. Content cues

This is the hero reel — direct the shots accordingly.

- **Overhead cam locked on the boarded pitch** the whole match — the signature scramble, now framed by the boards so the whole play area reads as one shot.
- **Onboard FPV** on 1–2 cars for the ball's-eye chaos.
- **Goal-cam** behind each goal mouth for the moment of the shot.
- Mic the **commentator** on goals and near-misses; cut goal + celebration for reels.
- Coloured LEDs + the light-up ball + the lit goal frame = the night-glow poster image. This is the shot that sells the brand.
- Capture: a first-timer's first goal (the reaction), the pile-up rebound off the boards, the golden goal, the final's trophy lift.

13. Pairs with

[[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]] (the prototype gate for the ball + the boards — build nothing here until it passes) · [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]] (full boost-system build + BOM) · [[TorqBall — Stretch Modes]] (Hoops/Puck/Rumble/Hazard Variant — build + test to unlock each) · [[TorqBall — What The Event Needs]] (the full standalone-event cost roll-up + ₹4L envelope check + timed run-of-show) · [[TorqBall — Design Study v1]] (why this shape, the locked decisions) · [[Event Ops Standards (all games)]] · [[Car Fleet, Scale & Protection]] (rented fleet, speed cap, foam bump-rings this reuses). TorqFall, TorqSiege and TorqCapture are their own separate events — nothing here shares a day, a floor or a schedule with them.

Verified + changelog (2026-09-06): first build superseding [[1 - TorqBall (rulebook)]]'s merged-day frame, from the locked [[TorqBall — Design Study v1]]. Reframed as a fully standalone event with its own boarded arena (reused the legacy 10×6.5 m / ~700 sq ft pitch footprint, now enclosed by ~35–45 cm dasher boards instead of open turf). Speced all three v1 modes (Standard 2v2/3v3, Duel 1v1, Big Party 4v4/6v6) with team size, clock and role; pointed the four stretch modes (Hoops, Puck, Rumble, Hazard/Arena Variant) to their own doc rather than duplicating the build detail here. Summarised the five-boost system (Plow/Scoop/Grabber/Turbo/Magnet) and boost-pad tech reuse from TorqCapture, with the call that Standard/Duel run boost-free by default and Big Party/Rumble turn pads on. Locked a group→knockouts→final tournament arc matching TorqFall/TorqSiege/TorqCapture. Wrote the marshal+tech match script, scoring/fouls (incl. the shared "no ramming a downed car" rule), safety, reset/turnaround and content cues. Explicitly gated the whole build behind [[TorqBall — Ball & Boards Test]] — nothing here is buildable until that prototype test passes.

Second pass (2026-09-06, examiner fixes): (1) **Magnet direction reconciled** — §6 now states explicitly "the goal you're attacking widens," matching [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]] and the corrected [[TorqBall — Design Study v1]] (which previously said the opposite — "your" goal widens). (2) **§4 per-match car count corrected** — the old flat "4–8 cars" band didn't cover Duel (2 live) or Big Party 6v6 (12 live); restated per-mode as Duel 2 · Standard 4–6 · Big Party 8–12, with the 12-live/12–16-fleet charging-margin call made explicit. (3) Linked the new [[TorqBall — What The Event Needs]] doc (full cost roll-up + envelope check + run-of-show, previously missing from this game's doc set). (4) **Turbo's §6 row corrected** to fleet-toggle-only, dropping the "boost lane" mechanism it previously listed alongside the toggle — a low-friction/sloped strip doesn't add speed, so it was never a real second option; see [[TorqBall — Boost & Attachments]] §2.

Third pass (2026-09-06, examiner fix): the first changelog paragraph above still said the legacy pitch was "~650 sq ft," a stale figure left over from before §3's own arena spec was corrected to **~700 sq ft** ($10\text{ m} \times 6.5\text{ m} = 65\text{ sq m} \approx 700\text{ sq ft}$). Changed the changelog wording to match the body it's describing — no arena spec changed, §3 was already correct.